

The 6:15

THURSDAY · SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

NO. 10

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Thu 9/3	Jobless claims (wk. 8/29), 8:30a — not yet out; prior wk. 203K
Fri 9/4	Aug. jobs report, 8:30a — cons. +53K–55K vs. July's –23K
Sat 9/5	Northwestern opens vs. South Dakota St., 7p CT
Sun 9/6	OPEC+ core-7 meets; delegates expect Q4 quotas held
Mon 9/7	Labor Day, markets closed — effective Anthropic prospectus deadline
Tue 9/8	Canada's \$27.6B retaliatory tariffs on U.S. imports take effect
Fri 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a (BLS)
Tue–Wed 9/15–16	FOMC; decision Wed 2p, presser 2:30p. Hike odds ~65–68%
[NEW]	Qwen3.8-Max-0902 released (9/2); no other verified model/launch/VC round this run

Correction: Colorado's 8th-district primary, listed yesterday as upcoming, was held June 30 — dropped.

METRICS · AS OF ~6:20A ET / 1020Z UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	\$95.1–95.3 (–0.4%, no settle) / \$91.85 vs. Wed settle \$91.81; spread ~\$3.4
2Y / 10Y / 30Y	4.38% / 4.79% / 5.26–5.27% (Wed close)
DXY / VIX	99.55 (–0.13%) / 15.2, down from Tue's >16 spike
Futures	S&P –0.05%, Nasdaq 100 –0.11%, Dow +0.07% (premarket)
Equities (Wed)	S&P 7,666.60 (+0.46%), Dow 53,061.95 (+0.56%), Nasdaq Comp. 26,217.83 (+0.45%)

Asia / Europe	Nikkei 64,255.73 (−0.11%), HSI flat / FTSE 10,756.45 (−0.30%), DAX 25,839.33 (−0.50%)
Gold / Gas	spot \$4,385 / fut. \$4,428 (+0.92%) (disagree); gas \$4.1203/gal (AAA, 9/2)

Oil sources of record: ICE Brent front-month, NYMEX WTI front-month; no settle at press time.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 186 (straits.live, 9/3)
Transits	PortWatch 6/day vs. 85 baseline (~7%); Kpler 5-day avg. 10, lowest since May; Lloyd's List 114 (8/17–23) stale
Dark fleet	29/40 vessels off-AIS at SE anchorage (72.5%, Kpler 8/31); window range 44–80%+
Congestion	465 vessels off berth (straits.live, 23:56 UTC 9/2)
Strikes (24h)	Iran claims strikes on Kuwait, UAE bases (single-sourced, unconfirmed)
Running total	12 seafarers killed/missing since 2/28 (single-sourced)
War-risk premium	~10% of hull value, ~40x peacetime (unchanged)

Kpler (near-real-time AIS), Lloyd's List (weekly aggregation) and PortWatch (baseline snapshots) measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	beat Angels 6-3 (10 inn., 9/2); 80-60, 2nd AL East, 3.5 GB Tampa Bay
Knicks	Hart extension (4-yr/\$81M) still finalizing, unsigned
Northwestern	off-season; opens Sat 9/5 vs. South Dakota St.

LEAD

HORMUZ WIDENS, MARKETS SHRUG

Iran claims overnight strikes on Kuwait and UAE bases; oil eases even as the Sidr's death toll is confirmed — leaving Friday's jobs report to set the next move

The escalation that defined Tuesday's session continued overnight rather than resolving. Iran's army said Thursday morning it struck Ahmed al-Jaber Air Base in Kuwait and Al Minhad Air Base in the UAE with missiles and drones — the first time this round of the conflict has reportedly reached targets in those two countries, following Tuesday's exchange that was previously confined to Jordan, Bahrain and Iraq's Kurdistan region. *[NEW]* Tehran's statement claimed strikes on satellite-communication systems, equipment depots and fighter-jet hangars at the Kuwaiti base, and troop positions and radar systems at the UAE base. *[flag: single-sourced to Iranian state media; no CENTCOM damage assessment or casualty report had surfaced as of this writing]* The claims land three days after CENTCOM's roughly 100-target response to the Sidr and Senegal Prosperity tanker attacks, and one day after the U.S. debuted its "tanker for tanker" doctrine by striking two Iranian government tankers directly — the specific escalation ladder Tuesday's issue flagged as having "a built-in expiration date, not a resolution." *[read: that read holds up so far; the question is whether Washington treats overnight strikes on Gulf-state soil, rather than on shipping, as crossing a different threshold than the tanker exchanges did.]*

The human cost of Monday's opening attack came into sharper focus this run: Saudi Arabia confirmed two of the sixteen Filipino crew aboard the tanker Sidr died when it was struck approaching the strait around 11:40pm local time Sunday into Monday; the remains have been moved to Oman and the fourteen survivors are being prepared for repatriation. *[NEW, fact]* That brings the crisis-wide toll to 12 seafarers killed or missing since fighting began February 28, by one

tracker's count [*flag: single-sourced*]. Riyadh has attributed the Sidr strike to Iran; Tehran has not claimed it specifically.

Mechanism: crude actually eased Thursday morning rather than extending Tuesday's spike — Brent fell roughly 0.4% to \$95.1–95.3, snapping a three-session rally, even as WTI held flat near \$91.85 against Wednesday's \$91.81 settle. [*fact, sources disagree to the decimal*] That is the notable divergence this run: a fresh, unconfirmed strike claim against two more Gulf states did not move the tape the way Tuesday's confirmed 100-target CENTCOM operation did. The VIX told a similar story, collapsing to 15.2 Thursday from Tuesday's brief pop above 16 — one of its sharpest single-week round trips this cycle. [*fact*] Two reads compete here, and this issue doesn't resolve them: either markets have already priced a baseline level of Gulf-state strikes as the new normal for this conflict and are waiting for evidence of actual disruption to tanker flows or Gulf energy infrastructure before repricing again, or last night's claims simply haven't been verified enough yet to trade on. [*read*] The Treasury market, similarly, barely moved — the 10-year sat at 4.79%, essentially unchanged from Tuesday's multi-month high, with CME FedWatch's September hike odds holding around 65–68%, roughly where they sat at Monday's close. [*fact*]

The second-order setup is that Friday's jobs report now lands directly into this ambiguity. A soft print (consensus clusters +53K to +55K, against July's –23K miss) would normally argue for the Fed to look past a supply-side oil bump; a hot one would reinforce Warsh's Jackson Hole framing at the worst possible moment for risk assets already digesting Wednesday night's other shock — Broadcom's stock fell 5% after hours despite beating on revenue and EPS, purely on Q4 guidance that came in about \$230 million light of the Street

(see Business). *[read: the market spent Wednesday drawing a hard line between a beat-and-raise it still wants to reward and a beat-and-slightly-undercut it's no longer willing to look past — a pickier tape than the one that greeted Nvidia and Marvell two weeks ago, which raises the bar for whatever ships out of Friday's jobs data and next week's CPI print.]* Equity futures were only marginally softer Thursday morning (S&P E-minis -0.05%, Nasdaq 100 E-minis -0.11%), suggesting the overnight Hormuz claims, at least, are not yet what's moving the tape. Gold's overnight move is the one indicator that did register the widening conflict: spot climbed to \$4,385 and futures to \$4,428, both up roughly 1% and extending a rebound that had already started Wednesday on the dollar's pullback — a haven bid that the equity and rates markets have not yet echoed. *[fact]* For a reader positioning ahead of the open, the practical takeaway is that today's real catalyst is still macro, not geopolitical: absent a CENTCOM confirmation of overnight damage or a fresh attack on shipping itself, Friday's payrolls print and the September 16 FOMC path are what will move this tape, with the Hormuz conflict now priced as a persistent-but-bounded risk rather than a fresh shock. *[read]*

POLITICS

President Trump signed the stopgap funding bill into law Wednesday — the "Continuing Appropriations and Extensions Act, 2027" — funding the government at current levels through December 11 and clearing the September 30 shutdown deadline that has loomed over the past several issues. *[DEVELOPING, resolved]* The bill passed 90-6 in the Senate and 370-48 in the House; nineteen House Republicans voted no, objecting to a Senate-added short-term delay of an intoxicating-hemp ban, though House Appropriations Chair

Tom Cole argued avoiding a shutdown ahead of the midterms took precedence. *[fact]* The bill also blocks OMB's proposed rule subjecting federal grants to political-appointee review and bars redirecting other program funds to Border Patrol — both carried over unchanged from Tuesday's summary. The next fiscal deadline is now December 11, past the midterm election.

ECONOMICS

Thursday's initial jobless claims (week ended 8/29), due 8:30am ET, were not yet out as of this writing; the prior week (ended 8/22) came in at 203,000, down 4,000. *[flag: pending]* The number that actually matters this week lands Friday: the August jobs report, where a consensus clustered at +53,000 to +55,000 has to clear a low bar set by July's -23,000 miss (against an original +83,000 consensus) — a bar low enough that even a modest positive print would read as a snap-back rather than confirmation of underlying strength. *[read]* Nothing in the claims data suggests the kind of deterioration the July payrolls miss implied; the gap between a resilient weekly-claims series and a negative monthly payrolls print is exactly the ambiguity Fed Chair Warsh's hawkish framing lets him resolve in either direction, and Friday's report is the last data point before it hardens into a September 16 decision. The inflation side of that framing rests on core PCE running at 3.7% over twelve months and 4.1% over six, per Warsh's own Jackson Hole citation — figures this issue has not independently re-verified against the BEA release this run but that continue to anchor every hike-odds estimate on the Board. *[flag: carried from Warsh's public remarks, not re-sourced to BEA this run]*

BUSINESS

Broadcom's fiscal Q3 numbers beat across every headline line — \$29.6 billion revenue (+86% Y/Y) against a \$29.43 billion consensus, non-GAAP EPS of \$3.32 versus \$3.24 expected, AI-semiconductor revenue of \$16.7 billion (+221% Y/Y, +54% Q/Q), and free cash flow of \$13.7 billion, or 46% of revenue. *[fact, NEW]* Net income more than tripled to \$13.09 billion. None of it mattered next to the Q4 guide: revenue of "approximately \$34.8 billion" against a Street looking for \$35.03 billion, with AI-semiconductor revenue guided to accelerate to \$21.7 billion (+236% Y/Y) — strong in isolation, but a sequential deceleration in the beat-versus-consensus margin that was enough to send shares down 5% in after-hours trading and open Thursday near \$369, off sharply from Wednesday's \$342–380 range. *[fact]* The reaction is a tell for how the AI-capex trade has shifted: a quarter this strong, delivered two weeks after Nvidia's and Marvell's own beats, was still punished for a guidance number roughly \$230 million light — a margin for error that didn't exist even a month ago, and this issue did not locate management's own explanation for the shortfall this run. *[read; flag: guide rationale not verified this run]* Elsewhere, the FTC's Amazon ad-pricing suit (filed Monday, alleging \$20 billion overcharged since 2019) had no docketed response from Amazon as of this run. *[continuity: unchanged since 9/2]*

TECHNOLOGY

Anthropic's IPO clock is now running against a hard mechanical deadline rather than a soft one: a prospectus must be public at least 15 days before the roadshow begins, which makes Monday's Labor Day holiday the effective trigger date for a filing if the company wants a September roadshow toward its targeted fall listing. *[DEVELOPING]* Reported target valuations continue to diverge

sharply by source — \$965 billion post-money from the last private round, versus figures as high as \$1.5–2 trillion floated around the prospective IPO — a spread this issue flags rather than resolves. *[flag]* Underlying the number: Bloomberg has reported annualized revenue run-rate above \$65 billion, up from roughly \$47 billion earlier in the disclosure cycle, with Q2 revenue above \$11.5 billion versus \$787 million a year earlier and positive adjusted operating income — the first frontier lab to show investors that metric. *[fact]* That revenue backdrop sits against the \$35 billion Lambda and \$45 billion Nscale compute commitments logged in yesterday's issue, still unreconciled against a company that hasn't yet filed publicly. Separately, Alibaba's Qwen team released Qwen3.8-Max-0902 on September 2 *[NEW]*; no other verified frontier release or rocket launch fell inside this run's search window. On funding: Amsterdam-based Wonderful raised \$550 million at a \$5 billion valuation for an AI operating system aimed at coordinating corporate AI workloads (9/1) *[NEW]* — below the multibillion-dollar compute deals dominating this week's AI headlines, but notable as a rare venture round in the AI-orchestration layer rather than infrastructure.

GEOPOLITICS

The EU is weighing a decision, expected September 7, on Ukraine's request for member states to fund additional Patriot batteries directly; von der Leyen said Wednesday the request was "going in the right direction" without confirming an amount. *[NEW]* Germany and Norway's previously reported three-battery commitment stands unchanged. Zelensky escalated his rhetoric on Russian airspace this run, warning that "Russian skies are becoming completely dangerous" for airlines and foreign governments and that the "Russian sky will be de facto closed" — a shift from pressing for interceptor deliveries toward threatening reciprocal disruption of Russian civil aviation. *[NEW, read: the shift in framing suggests Kyiv sees deep strikes on Russian infrastructure as producing more leverage right now than defensive Patriot requests, which is also consistent with the sixth-night bombardment of Kyiv reported in Tuesday's issue not yet having eased.]* Separately, Ukraine's SBU said it exchanged fire with its own military intelligence service, HUR, in Kyiv this run while investigating a Russian FSB plot to target a Russian opposition figure who had traveled to Kyiv for independence-day events — an unusual public admission of friction between Ukraine's own security services. *[NEW, flag: single-sourced, details of the incident and any casualties not independently verified this run]* Xi's September 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar with no new movement on export controls surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the overnight Kuwait/UAE claims (see Lead), the shipping picture is the most acute of this crisis cycle by the numbers: PortWatch's 6-transits-a-day reading (8/30) is roughly 7% of the 85/day pre-crisis baseline, congestion off berth hit 465 vessels as of Tuesday night UTC, and Kpler's dark-fleet sample shows the majority of vessels holding the southeast Hormuz anchorage now running without an active AIS signal. *[fact]* None of that squares cleanly with Energy Secretary Wright's since-unreconciled claim of 17 million barrels transiting the strait in a single day last week — a discrepancy flagged in Tuesday's issue that remains unaddressed by either side publicly and isn't repeated in full here per the no-repetition rule. OPEC+'s core-seven subgroup — a narrower body than the full cartel, worth distinguishing after this issue previously described it loosely — meets Sunday and is expected to signal Q4 quotas held steady, a decision that would leave supply policy unchanged through the current escalation regardless of how this week's strikes resolve. *[read]* Iran's own transit regime, imposed when it declared the U.S.-Iran memorandum of understanding void on August 19, remains the backdrop for every one of the transit figures on the Board: Tehran has required mandatory permits and maritime tolls for the strait since that date and has widened its shipping blacklist to 56 vessels, per Kpler's most recent count *[no fresher blacklist figure located this run]*. Kpler separately estimates the 60-day MoU window, while it lasted, cleared 374 million barrels of crude from the Gulf without ever fully reopening the strait — flows now running near 40% of 2025 levels by its measure, a baseline distinct from the daily transit-count methodology used elsewhere on the Board. *[fact]*

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Knicks	off-season. Hart extension (4-yr/\$81M) still finalizing.
Northwestern	off-season. Opens Sat 9/5 vs. South Dakota State, 7p CT.

Continuity. Resolved since 9/2: funding bill signed; further Iranian retaliation (now Kuwait/UAE, unconfirmed); Broadcom's print. Dropped as unchanged/stale: Metro Venetian attribution, Amara tanker status, Cook Fed case, Wright's 17M-barrel figure (still unreconciled), Colorado primary (corrected — already occurred).

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.